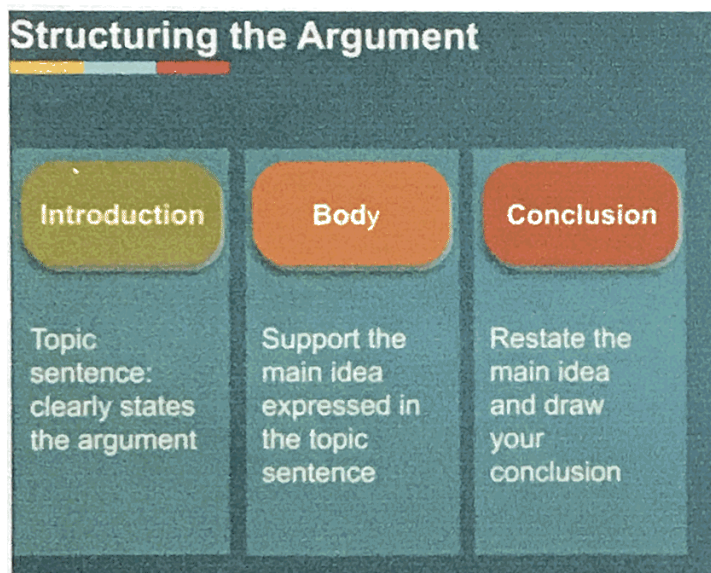


Video 1: Structure of Argumentative Paragraphs

Features of an Argumentative Paragraph

- Persuade the reader to agree with you
- Argue against or for a particular claim
- Persuasive paragraphs
- Uses factual evidence to prove that your claim is the most logical claim
- Example of a topic sentence: The argument that students from socially disadvantaged backgrounds cannot learn without the use of their mother tongue in the classroom is misplaced.



Organization of an Argumentative Paragraph

Claim

- Arguing about what
- Providing a reason for your claim
- Considering counterclaims

Evidence

- Quotes or examples
- Evidence with correct citations

Link

- What the evidence means
- Why the evidence supported your claim

Counterargument

- Why your claim should be acknowledged
- Why the contradictory arguments and objections are not strong or sustainable
- Introducing possible rebuttals and counterarguments

Video 2: Introductory Sentences and Evidence in Argumentative Paragraphs

Composing an Argumentative Paragraph

- A primary argumentative paragraph follows a general paragraph structure
 - An topic sentence clearly stating an argument
 - Supporting sentences covering evidence to support the argument
 - Concluding sentence re-emphasizing why the argument should be accepted

Introductory Sentences in Argumentative Paragraphs

- The topic sentence or the introductory sentence should specify the main idea you are arguing for or against:

Tobacco industry has a significant negative impact on the environment.

- It must clearly indicate the position, if any, taken by the author:

Education is the only way to control crimes against women.

- They should not be factual or only describe the scope of the paragraph:

Singapore has one of the best school education systems in the world.

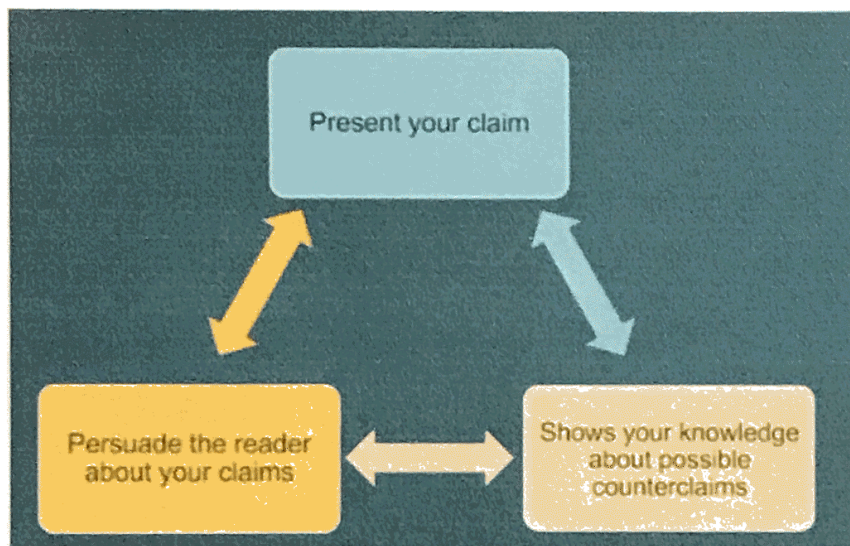
Evidence in Argumentative Paragraphs

- Primary documents, facts and statistics, relevant research findings, large scale survey results, etc.

- Evidence:
 - Accuracy
 - Reliability
 - Relevance to the main idea
 - Acceptability

Video 3: Why Claim and Counterclaim Method?

- Claims: Related to the evidence made for the topic sentence
- Counterclaims: Go against the claim



Claims

- Claims
 - Present the claim/argument regarding the proposed topic
 - Consider supporting evidence along with opposing evidence
- Proof
 - Present evidence supporting the claim
 - Ensure that sources are properly cited

- Link to claim
 - Showcase why the stated evidence proves your claims
 - Show your understanding of the topic by connecting the evidence to your claim

Counterclaims

- Acknowledgment
 - Acknowledge existing opposing claims
 - Anticipate readers' doubts
- Rebuttal
 - Argue against this possible opposing claim, showcasing the flaws in it
 - Establish the validity of your claim with a clear rebuttal backed with evidence
- Support
 - Put forth possible evidence
 - Conclude with support for your claim

Video 4 : Vocabulary for Argumentative Paragraphs

• Acknowledging others' ideas and opinions

insist	explain	present	conclude	argue
assert	claim	describe	examine	report
confirm	affirm	contend	deny	consider

Words to Agree/Disagree in an Argumentative Paragraph

agree	oppose	refute
disagree	prefer	concur
discuss	consider	dispute

Words to Acknowledge and Disagree with Opinions

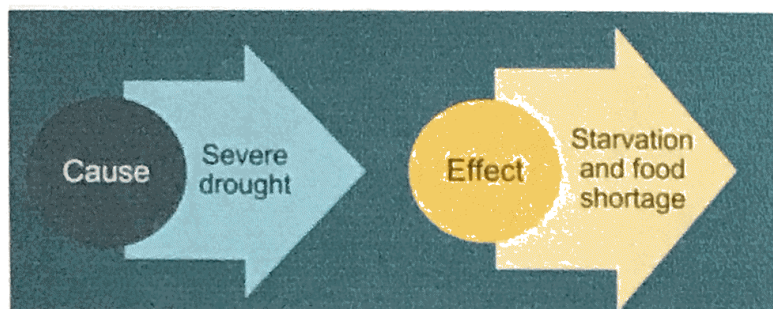
although	despite	nevertheless
whereas	however	while
but	yet	even though

Challenges to Presenting Arguments

- Demonstrating conviction and authority:
 - believe that investing in creating cost-effective materials can make the company more profitable.
- Sounding objective (not overtly emotional);
 - 'Global warming can wreak havoc on the entire human population.' VS. 'Global warming is a threat to human existence.'
- Maintaining logic and reason in building arguments:
 - Although it has not been conclusively proved, learning more languages can add to our cognitive capability as language learners.
 - Brain research suggests that their brains are more active and act faster when acquiring a new language.

Video 5: What Is a Cause-Effect Paragraph?

- Academic paragraphs can be effect-driven or cause-driven.



- Highlighting the relationship between the cause and effect

Elements of a Cause-Effect Paragraph

- Cause-driven
 - Cause + verb + effect: The COVID-19 pandemic caused panic among the residents. (resulted in/led to)
 - Conjunction + cause + verb and effect: Owing to pressure, the team failed to perform well in the semi-final match. (Because of/due to)
- Effect-driven
 - Effect + verb (passive) + cause: The accident was caused by a faulty switchboard.
 - Her outstanding performance was the result of her persistence and motivation.

Organizational Structure

- Point form: Cause-effect/effect-cause
- Evidence: Explanation
- Restatement of the main idea

Stat the main cause-effect idea —>

Description with evidence and commentary —>

Conclude with an emphasis on the cause-effect

Identify the Cause-Effect Structures

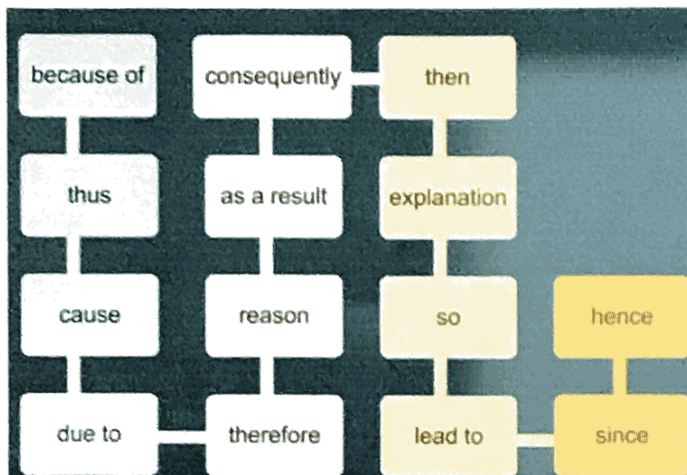
"In most developing nations, municipal wastewater treatment is limited to aerobic secondary treatments, expensive and ineffective in removing nutrients from treated effluents before discharge, resulting in eutrophication and imbalance in receiving bodies.

As a result, the effectiveness of *Chlorella vulgaris* for primarily treated wastewater collected from a sewage treatment plant during an 8-hour detention time was investigated in this study. . . . In addition, remarkable reduction was found in solids (TSS, TS and TDS) and EC concentration.

Language Use in Cause-Effect Paragraphs

Video 6 : Language Use in Cause-Effect Paragraphs

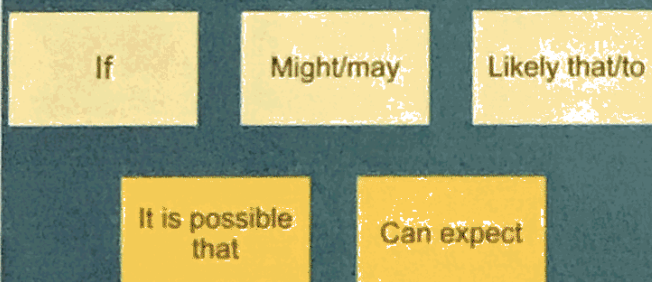
Signposts to establish causal relationships



Identifying Cause and Effect

- When you heat a piece of iron wire, **it expands.**
- **Human beings develop respiratory problems** when they breathe polluted air.
- **Ocean tides** are caused by the gravitational pull of the moon.
- **Rainbows** are formed by the sunlight shines through raindrops.
- **A whirlpool** is created when two opposing water currents meet.

- Prediction-based concluding sentences
- Vocabulary used in making such predictions



Example: If we continue to use water irresponsibly, **we will be left with no water in the future.**

Video 7 : Cause-Driven Paragraphs

- Describe the various causes that cause the particular effect.
- Each paragraph focuses on a particular cause
- Show the link to the effect
- Explain every component completely with examples and evidence

Example of Cause-Driven Paragraphs

Volcanic eruptions cause serious environmental pollutions. They release harmful gases, aerosol droplets, and ash into the atmosphere. While volcanic gases can have detrimental impact on the vegetation, exposure to those, especially sulphur dioxide and hydrogen fluoride, can damage the human respiratory system. When mixed with atmospheric water vapor, sulphur dioxide can induce acid rain. The resultant sulphate aerosols can reduce the atmospheric temperature and deplete the ozone layer. Lastly, though human beings are reasons behind the release of significant amount of carbon dioxide into the air, large volcanic eruptions can also inject large amounts of carbon dioxide. Since volcanic eruptions are beyond human control, the resulting pollutions can only be studied and little can be done to control such activities.

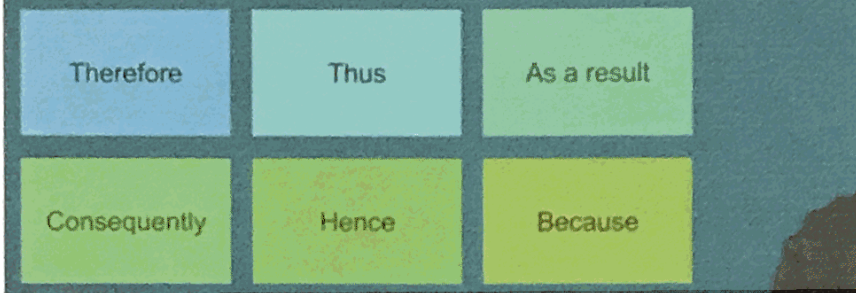
Video 8 : What Is an Effect-Driven Paragraph?

- Cause and effect paragraphs: describe the relationship between two or more events/factors
- Different types of cause-and-effect paragraphs:
 - One cause-one effect
 - One cause-several effects
 - Several causes-one effect
- Effect-driven paragraph: Highlighting the effects

Composing an Effect-Driven Paragraph

- Brainstorm ideas for effects
- Consider the impacts of the effects- significant or minor, past or future possibility of effects
- Explain the relationship between the ideas introduced or included
- Focus on effects
- Provide evidence to support the details of the effects
- From the most important to the least important

- Transition words/phrases that suggest an effect-driven paragraph



Example of an Effect-Driven Paragraph

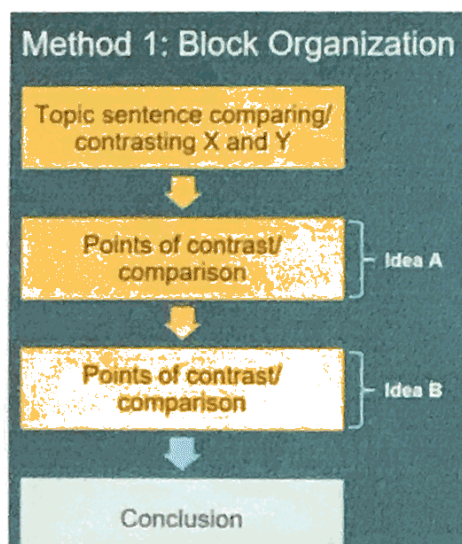
Example of an Effect-Driven Paragraph

Mountain bikes move smoothly even on rough surfaces due to the bikes' suspension system. A suspension system maintains the contact between the wheel and the ground. This keeps the biker's control and protects them from uneven surfaces. Suspension systems also lessen the vibrations in the bike, making the ride smooth. This is why proper suspension systems are critical in mountain bikes.

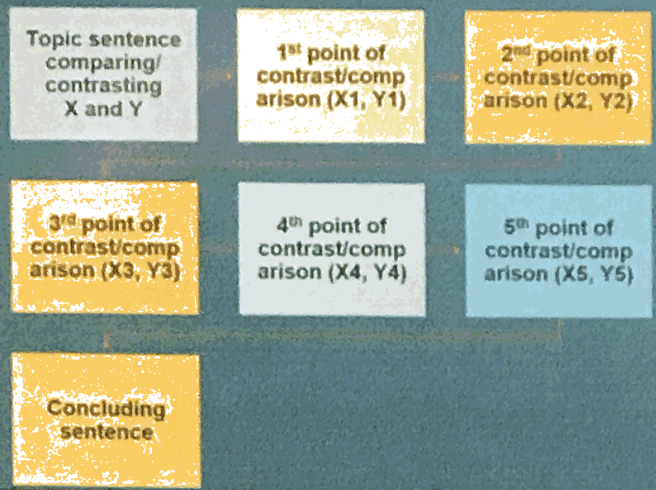
Video 9 : What Is a Comparison Paragraph?

- Compare:
 - How two ideas/ places/people/ objects are similar
- Contrast:
 - How two ideas/ places/people/ objects are different
- A popular academic writing genre
- Evidence for your argument
- Explaining with clarity and accuracy
- Compare or contrast or both

Comparative/Contrast Paragraph Structure



Method 2: Point-by-Point Organization



Comparative and Contrastive Structures

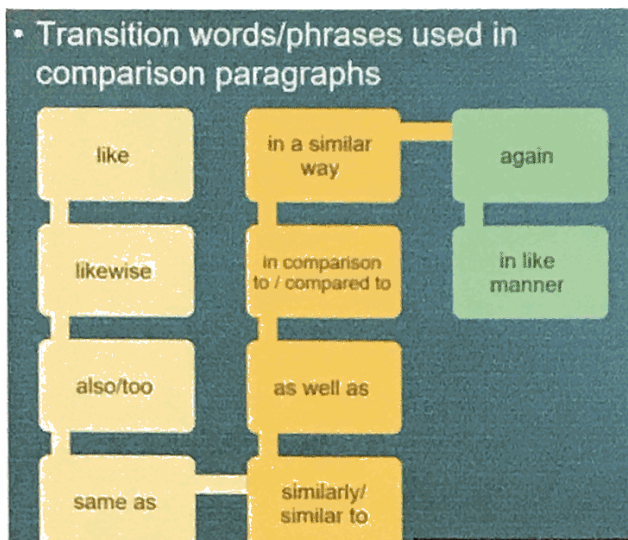
Commonly used words in comparative structures

And	Both	Both... and
Also	Too	Neither...n or
Similar to	The same as	(just) as + adjective + as
Likewise	Similarly	

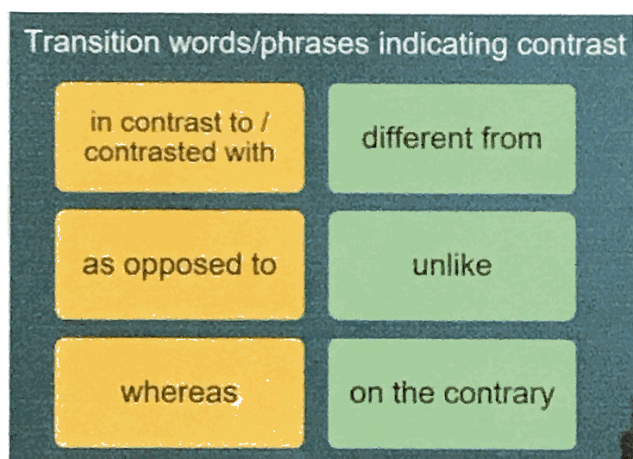
Commonly used words in contrastive structures

More/less + adjective/ adverb + than	Adjective + er + than	But/while/ though
Not the same as	Not as...as	Different from
In contrast	However	On the other hand

Video 10 : Language Use in Comparison Paragraphs



Language Use in Contrast Paragraphs



Structures Indicating Comparison

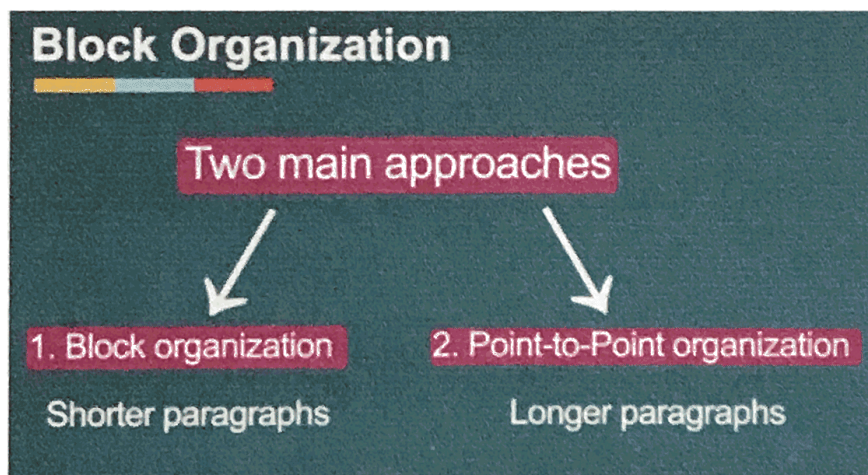
- Stating comparison
 - The paper aims to report a comparison a between.....
- Comparative degree use
 - The 12th generation computers are faster than
 - Most i7 computers are more gaming-friendly than i5 ones.

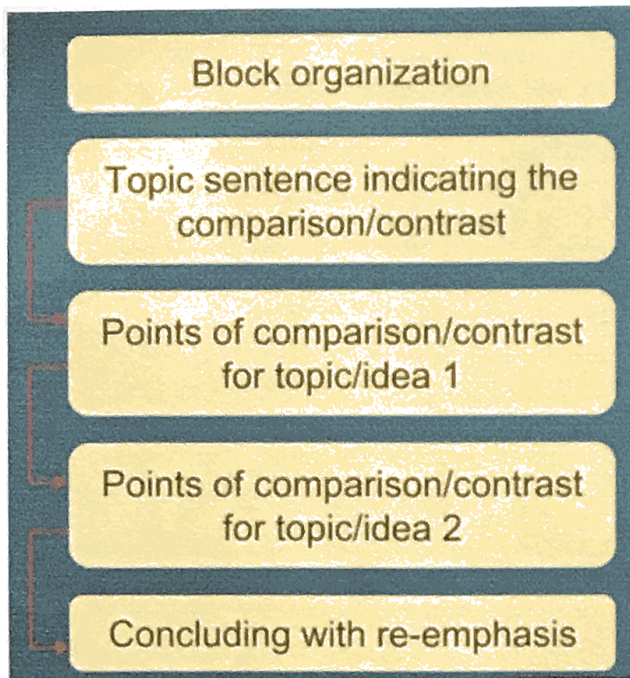
- Adverbs indicating comparison
 - A little more/slightly/significantly/substantially/relatively/comparatively
 - The 12th generation computers are faster than. ..
 - Most i7 computers are more gaming-friendly than i5 ones.

Use of Comparative Forms in Academic Writing

- Negative comparisons
 - Not as reliable as: number is not as reliable as quality when it comes to publishing research papers.
- Pre-modifying comparisons
 - The information available on Wikipedia is far more misleading.
 - The information available on the SCOPUS database is a lot more reliable.
- Post-modifying comparisons
 - They played better than before.
 - The temperature was lower than previously recorded.

Video 11 : Block Organization in Comparison Paragraphs





Example:

Android operating system and iOS are different from and similar to each other in many ways.

Google develops the Android operating system (OS) which is based on the Linux kernel.

Android OS is mainly used in smartphones and tablets. It can operate with 5G network. It is used by many smartphone companies across the world like Samsung, LG, Nokia, etc. On the other hand, Apple owns iOS.

It has a layered architecture. It is used by devices such as iPhone, iPod, iPad, etc., produced by Apple.

It can work with 5G network. Smartphones running iOS are usually costly. Android operating system and iOS have their unique features which help people choose smartphones.

Video 12 : Composing a Point-to-Point Comparison Paragraph

- Introduction:
 - Topic sentence comparing/contrasting two ideas/objects
- Middle:
 - Each sentence explaining a difference/similarity between the ideas/objects

- End:
 - Concluding the paragraph with restating the main idea--highlighting the comparison

Example of a Point-to-Point Comparison Paragraph

Though both hold digital data, a hard disk drive (HDD) is different from a solid state drive (SSD) in many ways. To begin with, an SSD uses electronic circuits for storage as opposed to an HDD where data are stored magnetically. Secondly, an SSD with its lower latency is faster than an HDD. Thirdly, an HDD uses more power as it has to rotate its platter which is not there in an SSD. Fourthly, the reliability and data transfer speed are higher in SSDs. Lastly, SSDs are costlier than HDDs. For all these reasons, SSDs are going to completely replace HDDs in the near future.

Points to Remember

- Clarity about the points of comparison/contrast
- Use of appropriate vocabulary indicating compare/contrast
- Maintaining coherence
- Following the main idea track
- Most important to least important
- Bringing a logical end through conclusion